

about the competition: "What is Bic doing? What do we hear from Schick? That's the battle, getting market share and losing market share." Mr. Raj had no free samples in his office, and said he hadn't bothered to try the new brown razor on himself.

Perhaps I shouldn't have mentioned that Ms. Hall was anxious to know what Mr. Raj was thinking, but I did. He didn't seem to care what Ms. Hall thought. He was more interested in what Diana Temple thought, and wondered if I'd been to see her over at Salomon Brothers.

I made an appointment to see Ms. Temple, which was easy to get after I told her secretary that Mr. Deepak Raj had suggested that I call. Ms. Temple's office was on the usual upper floor of a Water Street high-rise, though it lacked a view of the harbor.

Ms. Temple was a heavy-set woman who looked a bit older than her two colleagues I'd already visited. This was more or less confirmed when she said she'd been in toiletries for 15 years. Ms. Temple was also less ebullient than the other two, and she didn't seem to like Gillette.

It wasn't that she disliked Gillette *per se*, but that she thought the company would "lag the market" in earnings. "I wouldn't say 'sell' here, but the earnings growth will be below average," Ms. Temple said. "White Rain, though, has made some good inroads." Her own earnings estimate of \$5.60 a share was equal to Ms. Hall's estimate, yet she was cool on the company while Ms. Hall was crazy about it. I found this perplexing.

I brought up Ms. Hall's opinion, but Ms. Temple wasn't really interested. She was more anxious to know what Mr. Raj had been saying. She also mentioned an Alice Beebe Longley at Donaldson, Lufkin & Jenrette, which was where I headed next.

I checked in with Ms. Longley on the usual upper floor. She was as winsome as Ms. Hall, and she had the appealing habit of taking off her shoe and wiggling her toe during the conversation. It isn't the kind of detail worth mentioning in some professions, but on Wall Street, appearances were so well maintained that any sort of aberration was notable.

Ms. Longley mentioned she'd earned a Ph.D. in comparative literature. When I asked what this had to do with being an analyst, she laughed and said, "I used to take poems and analyze them to